Fırat Şeker

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Education

University of Massachusetts Amherst, Ph.D., Social Psychology — 2024 – Current

Kadir Has University, M.A., Psychological Sciences — 2021 – 2024

Dogus University, B.A., Psychology — 2017 – 2021

Publications

Mohammadsadegh, R., **Şeker, F.**, Kwak, Y. & Atari, M. (in press) Anthropomorphism and Emotional Reactions to Human-AI Collaboration across Cultures. *Technology, Mind, and Behavior*

Vurgun, R., Acem, E., **Şeker, F.**, Dogruyol, B., Isler, O., Bahçekapili, H. & Yilmaz, O. (in press) Cognitive Reflection Predicts Utilitarian Behavior in the Monetary Trolley Dilemma After 17 Months. *Judgment and Decision Making*

Şeker, F.*, Acem, E*., Vurgun, R., Dogruyol, B., Isler, O. & Yilmaz, O. (2026) Divine Verification: Introducing a CAPTCHA-based Religious Priming Technique. *Behavior Research Methods, 58*(316). https://doi.org/10.3758/s13428-026-03147-1

Harma, M., **Şeker, F.**, Dogruyol, B. & Yilmaz, O. (2026) Language Speaks Louder Than Performance: Linguistic Indicators of Cognitive Processing Across Common Threat Scenarios. *Applied Cognitive Psychology, 40*(3): e70216. https://doi.org/10.1002/acp.70216.

Şeker, F., Acem, E., Bayrak, F., Dogruyol, B., Isler, O., Bahçekapili, H. & Yilmaz, O. (2025) Cognitive Reflection and Religious Belief: A Test of Two Models. *Judgment and Decision Making, 20*, e13. https://doi.org/10.1017/jdm.2024.41

* denotes co-first authorship.

Book Chapters:

Atari, M., **Şeker, F.** & Zewail, A. (2026) Is Empathic AI Possible? In Cameron, C. D., & Perry, A. (Eds.), *Empathy and AI: Challenges, advances, and ethical considerations*(pp. 65-76). Cambridge University Press. https://doi.org/10.1017/9781009639057.008

Under Review Articles:

Şeker, F., Atari, M. (under review) Honor and Institutions Across Cultures.

Zewail, A., Setia, A., Mohammadsadegh, R., **Şeker, F.**, Hajian, A., Sosa, H.J., Gavireddy, S.R., Morhayim, L. & Atari, M. (revise and resubmit) Introducing the Cultural and Moral Expressions in Language (CAMEL) Corpus.

Hajian, A., Liu, G., **Şeker, F.**, Zewail, A., Mohammedsadegh, R., Graham, J., Haidt, J., & Atari, M. (under review) Measuring Moral Pluralism Efficiently Around the Globe.

Dogruyol, B., Acem, E., **Şeker, F.**, Vurgun, R., Isler, O., Gächter, S. & Yilmaz, O. (under review) From Attitudes to Behavior: Testing Morality as Cooperation and Moral Foundations Theory Across Time and Identity Groups.

Selected Articles In Preparation:

Şeker, F., Atari, M. (in preparation) Metamorality Across Cultures

Isler, O., Acem, E., Vurgun, R., **Şeker, F.**, Dogruyol, B., Bahcekapili, H.G. & Yilmaz, O. (in preparation) Beyond Religious Prosociality: Shared Beliefs Predict Moral Consistency

Preprints:

Toribio-Flórez, D., Cypris, N., Brüggemann, M., **Şeker, F.** & Baumert, A. (2022) A Closer Look at Third-Party Punishment Under the Risk of Counterpunishment: An Effect of Additional Material (and not Social) Costs.

Research Experience

Graduate Student Researcher Spt 2024 – Current

Culture and Morality Lab – Amherst, Massachusetts, USA

Lab Manager Jun 2023 – Aug 2024

Moral Intuitions Lab – Istanbul, Turkey

Research Assistant May 2019 – Aug 2024

Moral Intuitions Lab – Istanbul, Turkey

Research Intern Aug 2020 – Oct 2020

Max Planck Institute for Research on Collective Goods – Bonn, Germany

Conference Presentations

Şeker F. & Atari, M. (2026, September) *Metamorality Across Cultures*. Oral presentation (data blitz) at the International Society for Moral Psychology Conference, Ithaca, NY, United States.

Şeker F. & Atari, M. (2026, February) *Cultural Differences in Metamorality: Resolving Moral Conflict Across Societies*. Poster presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, Chicago, IL, United States.

Şeker F. & Atari, M. (2026, February) *Metamorality Across Cultures*. Poster presented at the Moral Psychology Preconference at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, Chicago, IL, United States.

Şeker F. & Atari, M. (2026, February) *Kinship, Collectivism, and Serial Killers: Cross-National Evidence.* Poster presented at the Historical Psychology Preconference at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, Chicago, IL, United States.

Şeker F., Acem E., Vurgun R., Isler O., Dogruyol B. & Yilmaz O. (2025, February) *Divine Verification: Introducing a CAPTCHA-based Religious Priming Technique.* Poster presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, Denver, CO, United States.

Harma, M., **Şeker F.**, Dogruyol, B. & Yilmaz, O. (2024, December) Reflections of Reactions to Different Threat Manipulations in Language. Oral presentation at the Annual Social Psychology Congress, Ankara, Turkey.

Şeker F., Acem E., Bayrak F., Yılmaz O., Dogruyol B., Isler O., & Bahcekapılı H. G. (2023, November). *The Relationship between Cognitive Reflection and Religiosity: A Test of Two Models.* Oral presentation at the National Symposium on Morality Studies in Social Psychology, Istanbul, Turkey.

Şeker F., Yilmaz O., Dogruyol B. & Isler O. (2023 November). Psychological Profiles of Left-wing Authoritarians. Oral presentation at the National Symposium on Morality Studies in Social Psychology, Istanbul, Turkey.

Şeker F., Aşık Y., Ceylan M. E., Yilmaz O., Doğruyol B. & Saribay S. A. (2022, October). *Left-wing Authoritarianism in Turkey.* Oral presentation at the Annual National Congress of Psychology, Istanbul, Turkey.

Günaydın G., **Şeker F.**, Velioğlu İ., Bayrak F., Alper S., Doğruyol B., Isler O. & Yilmaz O. (2022, October). *Scarcity, cooperation, and thinking styles: A theoretical test of the Self-control Account.* Oral presentation at the Annual National Congress of Psychology, Istanbul, Turkey.

Peer Review Experience

PNAS Nexus, Current Research in Ecological and Social Psychology, Personality and Individual Differences.

Teaching Experience

Guest Lecturer: Religion as an Identity Issue in the US. PSYCH 491: Advancing Diversity in Research and Practice. (University of Massachusetts Amherst)

Guest Lecturer: Evolution of Religion and Cooperation. PSYCH 491: Advancing Diversity in Research and Practice. (University of Massachusetts Amherst)

Teaching Associate/Instructor: PSYCH 337 – Writing in Psychological and Brain Sciences. (University of Massachusetts Amherst)

Teaching Assistant: PSYCH 240 – Statistics in Psychology. (University of Massachusetts Amherst)

Teaching Assistant: PSYCH 241 – Methods of Inquiry in Psychology. (University of Massachusetts Amherst)

Teaching Assistant: PSY 603: Advanced Theoretical Discussions in Psychological Sciences. (Kadir Has University)

Awards and Honors

University of Massachusetts Amherst 2025
STEM PhD Leadership Fellowship.

The SCORE Project for Advancing Research on Religion and Cooperation (SPARRC) 2025
Causal Inference Methodology Workshop Travel Award.

Association for the Study of Religion, Economics, and Culture (ASREC) 2025
Graduate Student Workshop Honorarium.